

COVER STORY OPINION POLL

20 | The Battle Cry

With the Mood of the Nation Poll predicting a photo-finish, regional chieftains are likely to play a key role in the selection of the next prime minister. It could even be one of them.

PROFILE VARUN GANDHI

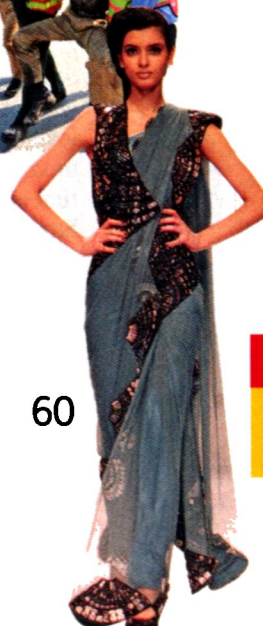
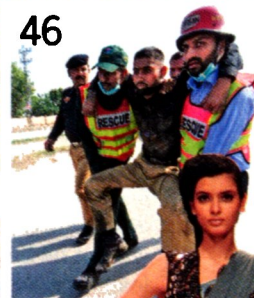
32 | The Dark Prince

A detention under the NSA has given Varun Gandhi what he has always craved. Both political relevance and a chance out of the oblivion he believes the more famous Gandhis have consigned him to.

STATES ANDHRA PRADESH

35 | Shaky Alliance

TDP chief N. Chandrababu Naidu is known for forging alliances but this time the mutual distrust among the partners threatens his prospects.



NEIGHBOURS PAKISTAN

46 | Crimson Tide

As terrorists strike at will, the war against rising militancy in Pakistan becomes a choice between the devil and the deep sea for the Zardari Government.

SPECIAL REPORT POST 26/11 RESPONSE

48 | A Total Failure

The first meeting of India Today's Board of Experts on Security and Terror finds the Government's response sorely wanting and anti-terror strategy yet to take off.

LEISURE FASHION

60 | Meltdown Makeover

Classic cuts and strong design details dominate the Lakme Fashion Week as designers cut costs to beat the financial slump.

13 OFFTRACK

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60 LEISURE

Jobs Today **68**

Take a look at the latest job offers in the Market.

Cover by SAURABH SINGH